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E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 2: Pronouns, word meaning and finding details – Handouts

Handout 2A: Follow the arrows

Draw an arrow from each bold word to the person or thing it means. Then write the answer.

1. Maria has two brothers. **They** live in Leeds. They = _____
2. The council sent Ahmed a letter. **He** put **it** in his bag and forgot about **it**. He = _____ it = _____
3. Nasra met her neighbours at the market. **She** invited **them** for tea. She = _____ them = _____
4. The bus was late and the passengers were cold. When **it** finally arrived, **they** cheered. it = _____ they = _____
5. Mr Chen gave the students a form. **He** asked **them** to return **it** by Friday. He = _____ them = _____ it = _____

Handout 2B: Two Wheels and a New Start

1 When Farid Rahimi arrived in London two years ago, he knew nobody. He lived in a hostel in Dalston and spent most of his money on bus fares. His English class was four miles away, so he travelled for nearly an hour each way.

2 One day his teacher, Mrs Okafor, told him about a bicycle workshop near the canal. **It** gives old bikes to people who need them. She wrote the address on a piece of paper and gave it to him. He went there the next Saturday.

3 The workshop was noisy and crowded. A mechanic called Rosa showed Farid a rusty blue bicycle. “It is yours,” she said, “but first you must repair it.” Farid had never fixed anything before. Rosa was patient. She taught him how to change a tyre and mend the brakes. After three Saturdays, **it** was ready.

4 The bicycle changed Farid’s life. He now gets to college in twenty minutes and he saves about fifteen pounds a week. He also feels healthier. At first, the busy roads frightened him, so he took a free cycling lesson from the council. Now he rides with confidence.

5 Farid still goes to the workshop every Saturday, but these days he is a volunteer. He helps new visitors choose a bike and shows **them** how to look after it. “Rosa gave me more than a bicycle,” he says. “She gave me a skill. I want to pass **it** on.”

Handout 2C: Questions on Two Wheels and a New Start

Name: _____ Date: _____

Section A: Pronouns. Circle A, B, C or D.

1. In paragraph 2, ‘It’ means:

- A. the canal
- B. the workshop
- C. the English class
- D. the hostel

2. In paragraph 3, ‘it was ready’ means:

- A. the tyre
- B. the piece of paper
- C. the bicycle
- D. the workshop

3. In paragraph 5, ‘them’ means:

- A. the bikes
- B. Rosa and Farid
- C. the Saturdays
- D. new visitors

4. In paragraph 5, ‘pass it on’ means pass on:

- A. the skill
- B. the bicycle
- C. the workshop
- D. the address

Section B: Word meaning. Find each word in the text. Write the clue, then your guess.

Word	Paragraph	Clue in the text	My guess
crowded	3		
patient	3		
mend	3		
frightened	4		
with confidence	4		

5. ‘Patient’ means:

- A. in a hurry
- B. calm and happy to wait
- C. unwell
- D. very strict

6. ‘Mend’ means:

- A. buy
- B. clean
- C. make something work again
- D. test

7. ‘Frightened him’ means:

- A. made him bored
- B. made him late
- C. made him angry
- D. made him afraid

8. ‘With confidence’ means:

- A. very slowly
- B. without fear

- C. every day
- D. with other people

Section C: Details. Circle A, B, C or D. Write the paragraph number next to your answer.

9. Before he had the bike, how long was Farid's journey to class?

- A. About twenty minutes
- B. Almost sixty minutes
- C. Two hours
- D. Four hours

10. Who first told Farid about the workshop?

- A. A mechanic
- B. Someone at the hostel
- C. The person who taught his class
- D. Someone from the council

11. What did Farid have to do before the bike was his?

- A. Pay fifteen pounds
- B. Do the repairs himself
- C. Pass a cycling test
- D. Work for free for three weeks

12. Why did Farid take a lesson from the council?

- A. He was nervous in traffic
- B. He wanted to become a mechanic
- C. His bike kept breaking
- D. The college asked him to

13. What does Farid do at the workshop now?

- A. He sells bikes
- B. He learns to change tyres
- C. He helps people who are new there
- D. He teaches English